

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	WATER TRUCK - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Signature: _____ 			
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	<u></u> Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training and skill.	Un-trained persons could cause injury to themselves and others. Possible property damage.	1	1. All persons on site must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card'. 2. All persons working on site must be suitably trained and competent in the work they are to perform. 3. No person shall operate mobile plant without the appropriate licence or competency assessment. The driver shall hold the relevant heavy vehicle Drivers Licence. 4. All work is carried out as directed by the Supervisor or customer representative.	Management Supervisor	2
Personal Protective Clothing & Equipment (PPE)	Personal injury.	1	1. Minimum PPE to be worn when working on site. • Hi visibility vests/clothing. • Steel toe-capped boots. • UV skin protection-minimum 30+ UV sunscreen. • Head protection as applicable eg hard hat with visor or sun hat depending on task at hand. • Long pants and long sleeves. • Hearing protection when required.	Truck driver	2
Pre Start Check	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident	1	1. Pre start checklist forms filled out & defects documented, Supervisor notified of any safety defects. 2. Water truck to have operational flashing light and reversing beeper. 3. Prior to commencement of work ensure the truck is fuelled and filled with water. 4. Ensure windows/ mirrors are clean. 5. Ensure all controls are in neutral or park. 6. Ensure all gear in the cabin is correctly stored. 7. Adjust the seat and use the seat belt.	Truck driver	2
Starting checks	Unsafe working conditions Increased likelihood of accident during operation	1	1. The operator must be seated and in full control of the truck when starting. 2. Check the operation of all of the controls and gauges. 3. Listen and watch for defects. 4. Test brakes, hand brake. 5. Test lights, horn and backup alarm. 6. Test steering, limiting devices and all equipment controls.	Truck driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Filling water tanker with fresh water.	Slips trips falls Manual handling hazards Overflow of water. Pressurising of tank.	2	1. Follow correct manual handling techniques to remove hose from stored location. 2. Use additional PPE where required eg gloves, safety goggles. 3. Ensure length of hose is sufficient for task. 4. Attach hose coupling. 5. Watch water level as tank is filling. 6. Bottom fill where possible. 7. Ensure 3 points of contact when climbing up and down from truck. 8. Ensure tank is vented to let air out and that overflow outlet is not obstructed.	Truck Driver	3
Filling water tank with dam, creek or river water	Bacteria may be present	2	1. After having had dam, creek or river water in tanker make sure the tank is flushed with freshwater and use chlorine to eliminate bacteria etc. before the next load of freshwater. 2. The water truck should be tagged with contents when using dam, creek or river water.	Truck Driver	3
Site Access	Various injuries from collision with traffic or other plant. Possible property damage.	1	1. Comply with speed limits on and around site. 2. Drive only in designated access routes. 3. Do not park vehicles where it will create a hazard to public vehicles, mobile plant, pedestrians or other workers. 4. Park on level ground. 5. Limit reversing on site where possible & use a truck controller where required.	Truck driver	2
	Hydraulic ram or hose failure	3	1. If possible do not leave site until arrangements are made to clean up oil spill, contact Supervisor or leading hand. 2. Use spill kit if applicable. 3. Warn or detour others around contaminated site.	Truck Driver	3
	Fall from height	1	1. Maintain 3 points of contact at all times when climbing up and down from water truck.	Truck Driver	2
Applying water	Traffic/Pedestrians	1	1. Ensure all audible and visual warning devices are operational. 2. Ensure water applied is uniform along pass. 3. Ensure turning area is adequate. 4. Maintain awareness of steep/unstable slopes. 5. Maintain awareness of vehicles and other machinery. 6. If using a spotter the spotter must be in view of operator at all times.		2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			7. Communication methods must be established before work begins.		
Vehicle shut down	Personnel struck by rolling plant. Site vision/vehicle obstructing vision of workers or public.	1	1. Assess parking area as to site vision for other works in the area (eg no parking where vision is blocked). 2. Park on firm, level ground where possible. 3. Park the machine up and down the slope when parking on a grade. 4. Park in a non operating area. 5. Park away from deep excavations and trenches. 6. Place the transmission in neutral or park position. 7. Idle the engine for gradual cooling before turning off 8. Remove the ignition key and secure the machine.	Truck Driver	2
Driving laden vehicles	Lose of control of vehicle Excessive movement may dislodge load.	1	1. Do not take any risks. 2. Water truck when less than 100%full may require a different driving technique as the effect of water escalating the roll effect of the vehicle.	Truck Driver	2
	Blown tyre	1	1. If a steer tyre has blown and you have a trailer, try to reduce speed and keep on road alignment if possible. 2. Apply trailer brake to slow the vehicle up. Also the maxi brake on the truck may be used. 3. Avoid the foot pedal as this will apply brake pressure to the steer axle and tend to make direction of steering more difficult.	Truck Driver	2
Environmental issues	Hydraulic oil spill	3	1. Make sure there is a visual check of all hydraulic hoses is part of your pre start check. 2. Should there be an extensive oil leak- clean it up immediately.	Truck Driver	3
Additional Safety Issue	Confined Space - Death	1	1. The Water Tanker itself is a confined space. 2. A sign is to be installed on the water tanker 'Confined Space Unauthorised Entry Prohibited 3. No person shall enter a confined space other than those with a confined space ticket.	Management Truck Driver	2
Administration requirements	N/A	-	4. The operator completes details onto the Delivery Docket at the end of each delivery. 5. For plant hire jobs the operator completes details into the Delivery Docket book at the end of each working day or at the completion of the particular job.	Truck Driver	-

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste asphalt will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.				
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card				
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training	

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.			
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Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity			
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.			

List of plant for this Activity			

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):			

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.